

Mini Assessment

API Handling & JSON Safety

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Questions & Answers

1. If an API returns 429, what should your program do?

Answer: HTTP 429 means **Too Many Requests**. The program should avoid sending requests continuously. It should wait and retry after a suitable delay. If the response provides a **Retry-After** value, the program should follow it. A limited number of retries with backoff is safer than retrying immediately.

2. If `response.json()` fails, what should your program do?

Answer: The response may not contain valid JSON—for example, the server may return HTML or plain text. The program should catch the JSON parsing error and handle it gracefully instead of crashing. It can check the response status/content type and use an appropriate fallback or error message.

3. If a JSON key is missing, why might `.get()` be safer than `[]`?

Answer: Using `data["key"]` raises a **KeyError** when the key does not exist. Using `data.get("key")` safely returns **None** when the key is missing, or a default value if one is provided. For example: `data.get("name", "Unknown")`.

Quick Revision

Status / Situation	What to do
429 Too Many Requests	Wait, respect Retry-After, then retry with limited backoff.
JSON parsing fails	Catch the parsing error and handle invalid/non-JSON responses safely.
JSON key may be missing	Prefer <code>.get("key")</code> or <code>.get("key", default)</code> when absence is expected.